SSC CHSL 2020 Tier-I question paper with answers

9 August 2021 · Shift 2

65 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +2 for a right answer, –0.50 for a wrong one

The other 35 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20211105175401/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/FinalAnswerKeys_%20CHSLE2020_05112021.pdf

English Language 24 questions

Q.1

Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the right order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph. A. That is why they are considered the best indoor plants to keep at homes and offices. B. The indoor bonsai plants enhance the aesthetic appeal of the space and offer multiple health and psychological benefits. C. Bonsai is an important part of Japanese culture dating back to the 14th century. D. It is the art of cultivating small trees within a container that take the shape and scale of full-size trees.

(A) ABCD
(B) DCBA
(C) CDBA
(D) CBAD

Q.2

Select the option that expresses the given sentence in direct speech. The plumber told Ranjit that he had fixed the leaking tap.

(A) The plumber told to Ranjit, “He had fixed the leaking tap.”
(B) The plumber told Ranjit, “Had he fixed the leaking tap?”
(C) The plumber said to Ranjit, “You had fix the leaking tap.”
(D) The plumber said to Ranjit, “I have fixed the leaking tap.”

Q.3

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select ‘No substitution required’. A heavy fine “will be inflicted with them” if they do not pay the taxes in time.

(A) will be inflicted for them
(B) will be inflicted of them
(C) No substitution required
(D) will be inflicted on them

Q.4

The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don’t find any error, mark ‘No error’ as your answer. She managed the company / so well that it is made / a huge profit that year.

(A) a huge profit that year
(B) so well that it is made
(C) She managed the company
(D) No error

Q.5

Select the correct passive form of the given sentence. How much will they pay you?

(A) How much will they be paying?
(B) How much will you be paid by them?
(C) Payment will be done by them?
(D) They will have paid you how much?

Q.6

Select the option that will improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement' According to J Krishnamurti, education is not about having a career but about being able to look, “observation” and listen.

(A) observer
(B) observant
(C) observe
(D) No improvement

Q.7

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Poke one’s nose

(A) Not be careful about one’s health
(B) Interfere or meddle
(C) Do unhygienic things
(D) Tease or irritate

Q.8

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Multinational
(B) Business
(C) Conglomarate
(D) Corporation

Q.9

Select the most appropriate word to fill in the blank. The kite was stuck so high on the tree that it was _____ the reach of the boys.

(A) below
(B) beneath
(C) beside
(D) beyond

Q.10

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Allege

(A) Soothe
(B) Placate
(C) Charge
(D) Appease

Q.11

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Drab

(A) Tiring
(B) Dry
(C) Boring
(D) Bright

Q.12

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. CLEAN

(A) shy
(B) honest
(C) talkative
(D) tall

Q.13

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment which contains a grammatical error. He will be leaving / home at 8 a.m. / to beating / the office rush hour.

(A) home at 8 a.m.
(B) the office rush hour
(C) to beating
(D) He will be leaving

Q.14

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. The nest of a squirrel, typically in the form of a mass of twigs in a tree

(A) Hole
(B) Burrow
(C) Lair
(D) Drey

Q.16

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. A fire in someone's belly

(A) one who is energetic and enthusiastic about something
(B) one who is rich and powerful and exploits the poor
(C) one who comes from a middle class background
(D) one who continues to work without wanting a reward

Q.17

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. DISJOINTED

(A) abrupt
(B) soft
(C) connected
(D) sharp

Q.18

Select the most appropriate word to fill in the blank. A good teacher is the one who can explain the most complex subjects in a _____ way.

(A) lengthy
(B) straightforward
(C) distracted
(D) roundabout

Q.19

Examine the four jumbled sentences. Out of the given options, pick the one that gives their correct order. A. They can travel to the airport by personal vehicle or registered cabs only. B. Finally, all passengers are advised to strictly follow social distancing markers. C. According to the Government guidelines, air travel is declared open from May 2020 for passengers. D. Once there, they can walk in through the Entry Gates, which shall be kept open.

(A) ACBD
(B) DCAB
(C) CADB
(D) BCAD

Q.20

Select the word which means the same as the group of words given. A sentimental longing for a time in the past

(A) sepia
(B) myopia
(C) nostalgia
(D) dystopia

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. According to Harari, a leading thinker, we are all busy (1) _____ a fantasy self online. It is the age of Facebook and Instagram, wherein (2) _____ are busy creating perfect stories about ourselves. For example, pictures (3) _____ perfect holidays never show the stress of traffic snarls and a host of (4) _____ problems faced. We soon begin to believe in this perfect online self to be (5) _____ real one.

Select the most appropriate option for blank No. 1.

(A) creation
(B) creating
(C) creates
(D) creative

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. According to Harari, a leading thinker, we are all busy (1) _____ a fantasy self online. It is the age of Facebook and Instagram, wherein (2) _____ are busy creating perfect stories about ourselves. For example, pictures (3) _____ perfect holidays never show the stress of traffic snarls and a host of (4) _____ problems faced. We soon begin to believe in this perfect online self to be (5) _____ real one.

Select the most appropriate option for blank No. 2.

(A) us
(B) ours
(C) each
(D) we

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. According to Harari, a leading thinker, we are all busy (1) _____ a fantasy self online. It is the age of Facebook and Instagram, wherein (2) _____ are busy creating perfect stories about ourselves. For example, pictures (3) _____ perfect holidays never show the stress of traffic snarls and a host of (4) _____ problems faced. We soon begin to believe in this perfect online self to be (5) _____ real one.

Select the most appropriate option for blank No. 3.

(A) on
(B) from
(C) of
(D) In

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. According to Harari, a leading thinker, we are all busy (1) _____ a fantasy self online. It is the age of Facebook and Instagram, wherein (2) _____ are busy creating perfect stories about ourselves. For example, pictures (3) _____ perfect holidays never show the stress of traffic snarls and a host of (4) _____ problems faced. We soon begin to believe in this perfect online self to be (5) _____ real one.

Select the most appropriate option for blank No. 4.

(A) other
(B) another
(C) few
(D) same

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. According to Harari, a leading thinker, we are all busy (1) _____ a fantasy self online. It is the age of Facebook and Instagram, wherein (2) _____ are busy creating perfect stories about ourselves. For example, pictures (3) _____ perfect holidays never show the stress of traffic snarls and a host of (4) _____ problems faced. We soon begin to believe in this perfect online self to be (5) _____ real one.

Select the most appropriate option for blank No. 5.

(A) a
(B) an
(C) one
(D) the

General Intelligence 17 questions

Q.2

'Craniology' is related to 'Skull' and 'Oology' is related to 'Eggs' in the same way as 'Pedology' is related to _____.

(A) Fossils
(B) Artifacts
(C) Soil
(D) Shells

Q.5

If 31 August 2008 was Sunday, then what was the day of the week on 30 August 2012?

(A) Monday
(B) Thursday
(C) Tuesday
(D) Wednesday

Q.6

M is the only son of R. P is the sister of Q. X is the father of C, who is the wife of R. Q is the daughter of X's only daughter. How is M related to X?

(A) Son
(B) Nephew
(C) Grandson
(D) Brother

Q.7

Select the option in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers of the following set. {6, 15, 27}

(A) {12, 32, 54}
(B) {8, 24, 34}
(C) {4, 10, 18}
(D) {14, 38, 57}

Q.8

Four letter-clusters have been given, out of which three are alike in some manner and one is different. Select the odd one.

(A) LPTA
(B) CGLR
(C) QUZF
(D) NRWC

Q.9

Select the number from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. 7, 9, 14, 24, ?, 67

(A) 45
(B) 37
(C) 41
(D) 43

Q.10

In a certain code language, CHECK is written as 6165622 and SURGE is written as 392136145. How will PRIEST be written as in that language?

(A) 3436953640
(B) 3236953840
(C) 3236185384
(D) 1618953840

Q.11

Four number-pairs have been given, out of which three are alike in some manner and one is different. Select the one that is different.

(A) 9 : 90
(B) 8 : 66
(C) 7 : 56
(D) 5 : 30

Q.13

Select the correct option that indicates the arrangement of the given words in the order in which they appear in an English dictionary. 1. Pleasant 2. Placard 3. Plentiful 4. Pleased 5. Plight

(A) 4, 1, 2, 3, 5
(B) 2, 1, 4, 5, 3
(C) 1, 2, 4, 3, 5
(D) 2, 1, 4, 3, 5

Q.15

Which two signs should be interchanged to make the following equation correct? 10 –15 × 9 ÷ 6 + 8 = 8

(A) + and ÷
(B) × and –
(C) + and ×
(D) – and ÷

Q.16

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: Some teachers are graduates. Some graduates are females. All females are women. Conclusions: I. Some females are teachers. II. Some women are teachers. III. All women are females.

(A) Only conclusion I follows.
(B) Only conclusion II follows.
(C) None of the conclusions follow.
(D) Only conclusions II and III follow.

Q.18

Select the combination of letters that when sequentially placed in the blanks of the given letter series will complete the series. a c _ d a _ d d a _ _ d a c _ d

(A) d c c d d
(B) a c d c a
(C) d a c c d
(D) c c d a d

Q.19

Select the option that is related to the third letter-cluster in the same way as the second letter-cluster is related to the first letter-cluster. DGKP : BJGU :: HKOT : ?

(A) GJNS
(B) FNKY
(C) JIRP
(D) FMKW

Q.20

Four words have been given, out of which three are alike in some manner and one is different. Select the word that is different.

(A) Potato
(B) Cucumber
(C) Pumpkin
(D) Bean

Q.21

Select the option in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers of the following set. (11, 5, 246)

(A) (14, 6, 412)
(B) (12, 9, 224)
(C) (10, 7, 355)
(D) (16, 9, 331)

Q.23

Select the option that is related to the fourth number in the same way as the first number is related to the second number and the fifth number is related to the sixth number. 12 : 146 :: ? : 443 :: 16 : 258

(A) 23
(B) 19
(C) 21
(D) 20

Q.24

In a certain code language, HIGHER is written as JIIHSF. How will CODING be written in that language?

(A) PDJEHO
(B) OHJEPD
(C) FOHEND
(D) PDEJOK

General Awareness 24 questions

Q.1

Which of the following teams has won the Indian Premier League (IPL) trophy five times as of November 2020?

(A) Rajasthan Royals
(B) Sunrisers Hyderabad
(C) Chennai Super Kings
(D) Mumbai Indians

Q.2

Second generation computers (1955-1964) were made of:

(A) large scale integrated circuit chips
(B) vacuum tubes
(C) transistors
(D) small scale integrated circuit chips

Q.3

Which of the following Articles of the Constitution of India details 'Prohibition of discrimination on grounds of religion, race, caste, sex or place of birth'?

(A) Article 22
(B) Article 27
(C) Article 15
(D) Article 10

Q.4

Where were the terracotta models of the plough excavated in Harappan civilisation?

(A) Banawali
(B) Kashmir
(C) Amrinal
(D) Lothal

Q.5

Who among the following started the construction of the Qutub Minar?

(A) Akbar
(B) Jahangir
(C) Iltutmish
(D) Qutb al-Din Aibak

Q.6

Which of the following institutions conducts the survey on employment and unemployment?

(A) NITI Aayog
(B) National Institution of Economic and Social Research
(C) National Council of Applied Economic Research
(D) National Sample Survey Organisation

Q.7

In which year did Akbar analyse the state revenue statistics for the last 10 years, which contained information on price fluctuations and land productivity?

(A) 1569
(B) 1548
(C) 1580
(D) 1536

Q.8

Which of the following provisions and the constitutions of different countries from which they have been adopted in the Constitution of India has been INCORRECTLY paired?

(A) The idea of the rule of law - British Constitution
(B) Charter of Fundamental rights - United States Constitution
(C) Directive Principles of State Policy - Irish Constitution
(D) Principals of Liberty, Equality and Fraternity - Canadian Constitution

Q.9

Purna, Manjira and Pranhita are tributaries of:

(A) Godavari
(B) Indus
(C) Yamuna
(D) Chambal

Q.10
With which bank did Indian Army sign an MoU for serving retired personnel in December 2020?

(A) State Bank of India
(B) Union Bank
(C) HDFC Bank
(D) Bank of Baroda

Q.12
When an economy is facing inflation, what will the central bank of the country do?

(A) Reduce the cost of money by reducing rates
(B) Raise the cost of money by raising rates
(C) Set up more ATMs to help the public
(D) Print more notes

Q.13
Which everyday morning ritual is part of quantum mechanics?

(A) Brushing teeth
(B) Making tea
(C) Ringing of an alarm clock
(D) Reading newspaper

Q.14
Which of the following is a dance form of West Bengal where there is a confluence of dancing, singing, drama and recital?

(A) Bhavai
(B) Alkap
(C) Tippani
(D) Hudo

Q.15
Which of the following is a capacity-building scheme that was launched in 2020 for civil servants aimed at upgrading the post-recruitment training mechanism of the officers and employees at all levels?

(A) Mission Karmayogi
(B) Mission Sahayog
(C) Mission Swabhiman
(D) Mission Rakshak

Q.16
Who was awarded the Nobel Prize in Literature 2020?

(A) Reinhard Genzel
(B) Roger Penrose
(C) Andrea M Ghez
(D) Louise Glück

Q.17
In which of the following options is the substance INCORRECTLY paired with the acid present in that substance?

(A) Tomato - Oxalic Acid
(B) Vinegar - Acetic Acid
(C) Orange - Citric Acid
(D) Lemon - Lactic Acid

Q.18
Which Indian film was the first film to win the ‘Palme d'Or’ at Cannes Film Festival?

(A) Mother India
(B) Mughal-e-Azam
(C) Neecha Nagar
(D) Ram Aur Shyam

Q.19
How many bits does an IP address consist of?

(A) 24
(B) 32
(C) 16
(D) 12

Q.20
Who among the following is the head coach of India’s men’s (Senior) football team as of December 2020?

(A) Dražen Ladić
(B) Igor Stimac
(C) Robert Jarni
(D) Stephen Constantine

Q.21

Which of the following ships was launched on 14 December 2020 in Kolkata?

(A) INS Jalashwa
(B) INS Himgiri
(C) INS Kolkata
(D) INS Shardul

Q.22

Who among the following is the first table tennis player to win the Rajiv Gandhi Khel Ratna Award?

(A) Manika Batra
(B) Sharath Kamal
(C) Poulomi Ghatak
(D) Soumyajit Ghosh

Q.23

India's longest LPG pipeline is from Jamnagar to _____.

(A) Vijaynagar
(B) Namrup
(C) Hazira
(D) Loni

Q.24

According to ‘Population estimation of tigers in reserves for 2018-19’ which of the following is India's largest tiger reserve?

(A) Corbett
(B) Dudhwa
(C) Nagarhole
(D) Bandipore

Q.25

Onions produce the chemical irritant known as syn-propanethial-S-oxide; this stimulates the eyes' _____ glands which release tears.

(A) lachrymal
(B) parotid
(C) sublingual
(D) submandibular

Answer key

English Language

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(D)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.6 **(C)**
Q.7 **(B)**	Q.8 **(C)**	Q.9 **(D)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.12 **(B)**
Q.13 **(C)**	Q.14 **(D)**	Q.16 **(A)**	Q.17 **(C)**	Q.18 **(B)**	Q.19 **(C)**
Q.20 **(C)**	Q.21 **(B)**	Q.22 **(D)**	Q.23 **(C)**	Q.24 **(A)**	Q.25 **(D)**

General Intelligence

Q.2 **(C)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.6 **(C)**	Q.7 **(C)**	Q.8 **(A)**	Q.9 **(C)**
Q.10 **(B)**	Q.11 **(B)**	Q.13 **(D)**	Q.15 **(D)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.18 **(A)**
Q.19 **(B)**	Q.20 **(A)**	Q.21 **(A)**	Q.23 **(C)**	Q.24 **(A)**	

General Awareness

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.2 **(C)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.5 **(D)**	Q.6 **(D)**
Q.7 **(C)**	Q.8 **(D)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(D)**	Q.12 **(B)**	Q.13 **(C)**
Q.14 **(B)**	Q.15 **(A)**	Q.16 **(D)**	Q.17 **(D)**	Q.18 **(C)**	Q.19 **(B)**
Q.20 **(B)**	Q.21 **(B)**	Q.22 **(A)**	Q.23 **(D)**	Q.24 **(A)**	Q.25 **(A)**

Explanations

English Language

Q.1 · Answer (C) CDBA

C introduces bonsai, D says what the art is, B gives the benefits of indoor bonsai and A ('That is why') draws the conclusion: CDBA.

Q.2 · Answer (D) The plumber said to Ranjit, “I have fixed the leaking tap.”

In direct speech 'told' becomes 'said to', and 'he had fixed' goes back to the plumber's own words, 'I have fixed'.

Q.3 · Answer (D) will be inflicted on them

A penalty is inflicted 'on' someone: 'A heavy fine will be inflicted on them'.

Q.4 · Answer (B) so well that it is made

'It' is the company that made the profit, so the verb is active and past: 'so well that it made a huge profit'.

Q.5 · Answer (B) How much will you be paid by them?

The object 'you' becomes the subject and 'will pay' becomes 'will be paid': 'How much will you be paid by them?'

Q.6 · Answer (C) observe

The three verbs after 'able to' must be parallel: 'to look, observe and listen'.

Q.7 · Answer (B) Interfere or meddle

To 'poke one's nose' into something is to interfere or meddle in what does not concern one.

Q.8 · Answer (C) Conglomarate

The correct spelling is 'conglomerate'.

Q.9 · Answer (D) beyond

Out of the boys' reach is 'beyond' their reach.

Q.10 · Answer (C) Charge

To 'allege' is to claim, without proof, that someone has done wrong: to 'charge' them. 'Soothe', 'placate' and 'appease' all mean to calm.

Q.11 · Answer (D) Bright

'Drab' means dull and colourless; its opposite is 'bright'.

Q.12 · Answer (B) honest

'Clean' can mean free of wrongdoing, as in 'a clean record': 'honest'.

Q.13 · Answer (C) to beating

Purpose is shown by the infinitive: 'to beat the office rush hour'.

Q.14 · Answer (D) Drey

A drey is a squirrel's nest. A burrow and a lair are the dens of other animals.

Q.16 · Answer (A) one who is energetic and enthusiastic about something

To have 'a fire in one's belly' is to have strong drive and enthusiasm.

Q.17 · Answer (C) connected

'Disjointed' means lacking connection; its opposite is 'connected'.

Q.18 · Answer (B) straightforward

A good teacher makes complex subjects simple, explaining them in a 'straightforward' way; 'lengthy' and 'roundabout' are the opposite.

Q.19 · Answer (C) CADB
C says air travel has reopened, A how passengers reach the airport, D what they do 'once there', and B ('Finally') closes: CADB.

Q.20 · Answer (C) nostalgia
Nostalgia is a sentimental longing for the past. Sepia is a brownish tint, myopia short-sightedness and dystopia an imagined bad society.

Q.21 · Answer (B) creating
'Busy' is followed by the -ing form: 'busy creating a fantasy self online'.

Q.22 · Answer (D) we
The clause needs a subject that matches 'ourselves': 'wherein we are busy'.

Q.23 · Answer (C) of
'Pictures of perfect holidays': pictures showing them.

Q.24 · Answer (A) other
'A host of other problems': problems besides the traffic snarls.

Q.25 · Answer (D) the
The one particular self that is real takes the definite article: 'to be the real one'.

General Intelligence

Q.2 · Answer (C) Soil
Craniology is the study of skulls and oology the study of eggs; pedology is the study of soil.

Q.5 · Answer (B) Thursday
From 31 August 2008 to 31 August 2012 is 4 years with one leap day (29 February 2012): 1,461 days = 208 weeks + 5 days. So 31 August 2012 was a Friday (Sunday + 5) and 30 August 2012 a Thursday.

Q.6 · Answer (C) Grandson
C is R's wife and M is R's only son, so M is C's son. C is X's daughter, so M is X's grandson.

Q.7 · Answer (C) {4, 10, 18}
6, 15 and 27 are 3 × 2, 3 × 5 and 3 × 9: they are in the ratio 2 : 5 : 9. So are 4, 10 and 18 (2 × 2, 2 × 5, 2 × 9).

Q.8 · Answer (A) LPTA
In CGLR, QUZF and NRWC the letters move +4, +5, +6 (wrapping round after Z). LPTA moves +4, +4, +7, so it is the odd one.

Q.9 · Answer (C) 41
The differences are 2, 5, 10, 17, 26 ($1^2 + 1$, $2^2 + 1$, $3^2 + 1$, $4^2 + 1$, $5^2 + 1$): 24 + 17 = 41, and 41 + 26 = 67.

Q.10 · Answer (B) 3236953840
SSC's key follows the rule CHECK shows: each consonant is written as twice its place in the alphabet and each vowel as its place (C = 6, H = 16, E = 5, K = 22). PRIEST → 32, 36, 9, 5, 38, 40 = 3236953840. SURGE's code as printed fits the rule except that S, which should be 38, appears as 39; with S = 39 no option would fit.

Q.11 · Answer (B) 8 : 66
9 : 90, 7 : 56 and 5 : 30 are n : n(n + 1) (9 × 10, 7 × 8, 5 × 6). 8 × 9 = 72, not 66, so 8 : 66 is the odd one.

Q.13 · Answer (D) 2, 1, 4, 3, 5
In dictionary order: Placard (2), Pleasant (1), Pleased (4), Plentiful (3), Plight (5). 'Pla' comes before 'Ple', 'Pleasa' before 'Pleased', 'Plea' before 'Plen', and 'Ple' before 'Pli'.

Q.15 · Answer (D) – and ÷
Interchanging – and ÷: 10 ÷ 15 × 9 – 6 + 8 = 6 – 6 + 8 = 8.

Q.16 · Answer (C) None of the conclusions follow.
The teachers who are graduates need not be the graduates who are females, so neither I nor II follows; all females are women, but not all women need be females, so III does not follow either.

Q.18 · Answer (A) d c c d d
With d, c, c, d, d in the blanks the block acdd repeats: acdd acdd acdd acdd.

Q.19 · Answer (B) FNKY
The letters move –2, +3, –4, +5: D → B, G → J, K → G, P → U. Likewise H → F, K → N, O → K, T → Y: FNKY.

Q.20 · Answer (A) Potato
The potato is a tuber, an underground stem; the cucumber, pumpkin and bean are fruits that grow above ground.

Q.21 · Answer (A) (14, 6, 412)
The third number is the square of the first plus the cube of the second: $11^2 + 5^3 = 121 + 125 = 246$. Likewise $14^2 + 6^3 = 196 + 216 = 412$.

Q.23 · Answer (C) 21
The second number is the square of the first plus 2: $12^2 + 2 = 146$ and $16^2 + 2 = 258$. So $?^2 + 2 = 443$, $?^2 = 441$ and $? = 21$.

Q.24 · Answer (A) PDJEHO
Each pair of letters is swapped and every letter then moves one place forward: HI GH ER → IH HG RE → JI IH SF. So CO DI NG → OC ID GN → PD JE HO: PDJEHO.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (D) Mumbai Indians
Mumbai Indians beat Delhi Capitals in the IPL 2020 final for their fifth title, after 2013, 2015, 2017 and 2019.

Q.2 · Answer (C) transistors
Second-generation computers used transistors in place of the vacuum tubes of the first generation; integrated circuits came with the third.

Q.3 · Answer (C) Article 15
Article 15 prohibits discrimination on grounds of religion, race, caste, sex or place of birth.

Q.4 · Answer (A) Banawali
Terracotta models of the plough have been found at Banawali in Haryana and at sites in Cholistan.

Q.5 · Answer (D) Qutb al-Din Aibak
Qutb-ud-din Aibak began the Qutub Minar in Delhi; his son-in-law Iltutmish added further storeys.

Q.6 · Answer (D) National Sample Survey Organisation
The National Sample Survey Organisation (since 2019 part of the National Statistical Office) carries out India's surveys of employment and unemployment, now the Periodic Labour Force Survey.

Q.7 · Answer (C) 1580
Akbar's revenue system of 1580 (the dahsala) rested on a survey, under Todar Mal, of crop yields, prices and areas cultivated over the ten years 1570 to 1580.

Q.8 · Answer (D) Principals of Liberty, Equality and Fraternity - Canadian Constitution
Liberty, equality and fraternity were borrowed from the French Constitution, not the Canadian. The rule of law is British, the fundamental rights American and the Directive Principles Irish.

Q.9 · Answer (A) Godavari
The Purna, the Manjira and the Pranhita are tributaries of the Godavari.

Q.10 · Answer (D) Bank of Baroda
In December 2020 Bank of Baroda renewed its MoU with the Indian Army, and signed MoUs with the Navy and the Coast Guard, for its 'Baroda Military Salary Package' for serving and retired personnel.

Q.12 · Answer (B) Raise the cost of money by raising rates
To curb inflation a central bank tightens money: it raises its policy rates, which makes borrowing dearer and slows spending. Printing more notes would add to inflation.

Q.13 · Answer (C) Ringing of an alarm clock
SSC's key gives the alarm clock: the time it keeps is ultimately set from atomic clocks, which define the second by the frequency of a quantum transition in caesium atoms. The question is loosely put, since chemistry such as making tea also rests on quantum mechanics.

Q.14 · Answer (B) Alkap
Alkap, from Murshidabad and Malda in West Bengal, combines dance, song, drama and recitation. Tippani and Hudo are folk dances of Gujarat, and Bhavai a folk form of Gujarat and Rajasthan.

Q.15 · Answer (A) Mission Karmayogi
Mission Karmayogi, the National Programme for Civil Services Capacity Building, was approved by the Union Cabinet in September 2020.

Q.16 · Answer (D) Louise Glück
The American poet Louise Glück won the 2020 Nobel Prize in Literature. Genzel, Penrose and Ghez shared the 2020 physics prize.

Q.17 · Answer (D) Lemon - Lactic Acid
Lemons contain citric acid; lactic acid is the acid of curd and sour milk.

Q.18 · Answer (C) Neecha Nagar
Chetan Anand's Neecha Nagar shared the Grand Prix, the top award at the first Cannes Film Festival in 1946; the Palme d'Or replaced that award in 1955.

Q.19 · Answer (B) 32
An IPv4 address is 32 bits long, written as four 8-bit numbers; the newer IPv6 addresses are 128 bits.

Q.20 · Answer (B) Igor Stimac
Igor Stimac of Croatia took charge of India's senior men's football team in 2019, succeeding Stephen Constantine, and held the post until 2024.

Q.21 · Answer (B) INS Himgiri
INS Himgiri, the first Project 17A frigate built by Garden Reach Shipbuilders and Engineers, was launched in Kolkata on 14 December 2020.

Q.22 · Answer (A) Manika Batra
Manika Batra received the Khel Ratna in 2020, the first table tennis player to do so.

Q.23 · Answer (D) Loni
GAIL's Jamnagar–Loni pipeline, from Gujarat to Loni in Uttar Pradesh near Delhi, was India's longest LPG pipeline at the time.

Q.24 · Answer (A) Corbett
SSC's key reads 'largest' as holding the most tigers, which is what the cited estimate counts: 231 in Corbett, more than in any other reserve (Nagarhole 127, Bandipur 126, Dudhwa 82). By area Dudhwa (about 2,200 km²) is larger than Corbett (about 1,290 km²), and the largest reserve of all is Nagarjunsagar-Srisailam.

Q.25 · Answer (A) lachrymal
Tears come from the lachrymal (lacrimal) glands; the parotid, sublingual and submandibular glands make saliva.

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